5E LESSON PLAN: WEEK 3 – MISS PATTERSON

- **Institution:** Happy Grove High School
- **Grade Level:** Grade 8
- **Class:** 8^3
- **Subject:** English Literature
- **Date:** September 21, 2026
- **Duration:** 60 minutes
- **NSC Learning Strand:** Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature)
- **NSC Attainment Target:** Identify and comment on structural features and language choices that writers use to create characters and settings; communicate with competence and confidence using text evidence.
- **Topic:** Characterization – Analyzing External Traits in Chapters 2 & 3
- **Previous Knowledge:** In Week 2, students learned setting and atmosphere and compared Robin Hill and River Bottom in Chapter 1.

Key Vocabulary

Key Vocabulary (word wall)

External characterization: how a writer shows what a character is like on the outside

External trait: a feature we can see: appearance, clothing, posture, expression

Internal trait: a quality on the inside: personality, values, feelings

Protagonist: the main character whose goals drive the story

Antagonist: the character who opposes the protagonist

Status: a person's position or importance in society

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson:

Cognitive

1. After the Engage discussion, students will distinguish physical appearance from personality traits, correctly sorting at least four of five trait examples.
2. Using Chapters 2 and 3, students will extract three physical details describing Sun-Sun Johnson or Jake Hibbertson, with the page number for each.

Affective

3. During pair work, students will support every trait they record with a quote from the text, separating facts from personal assumptions.

Psychomotor

4. Using the Character Body-Outline Organizer, students will write at least three physical markers (clothing, posture, expression) in the correct zones for their assigned character.

Learning Domains

- **Cognitive:** Define external traits; analyse text descriptions; contrast physical differences using quotes.
- **Affective:** Recognize that outward appearances do not fully reveal a person's character or value.
- **Psychomotor:** Select, group and record details on a body-outline organizer.

Learning Styles

- **Visual:** Body-outline organizers and the comparison columns on the board.
- **Auditory:** Paired reading and whole-class questioning.
- **Kinaesthetic:** Underlining text evidence and sorting trait cards.

Resources

- A neatly wrapped gift parcel and a worn cardboard box (in Engage below)
- Class copies of My Father, Sun-Sun Johnson (Chapters 2–3)
- Draft worksheet and pair role slips (in Explore below)
- Double-sided Character Body-Outline Organizer (in Elaborate below)
- Vocabulary Wall cards
- KWL charts and exit tickets
- PowerPoint and whiteboard

NSC Major Objectives (Curriculum Alignment)

- Infer the author's point of view and purpose from text read. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 2). Checked by: Exit Ticket Q2–3 (what Jake's appearance shows about his status).*
- Locate and analyse an author's use of figurative language including allusion, idiom, pun and symbolism in a variety of literary text. *(Reading for Meaning and Enjoyment (Comprehension & Literature) – Term 1, Unit 2). Checked by: Character Body-Outline Organizer (how clothing and posture stand for status).*

Instructional Strategies

- **KWL Chart:** Engage – what students know and want to know about characters.
- **Realia / Object Lesson:** Engage – a wrapped gift parcel and a worn box introduce first impressions.
- **Vocabulary Wall:** Engage – the key term External Characterization is posted for the unit.
- **Jigsaw with Role Slips:** Explore – half the class tracks Sun-Sun (Chapter 2), half tracks Jake (Chapter 3), then teams share findings.
- **Text Evidence Extraction:** Explore – pairs record three exact quotes about appearance, dress or movement.
- **Student Presentations:** Explain – team representatives present their evidence.
- **Higher-Order Questioning:** Explain – "Where in the text does it say that?" and analyse, compare, evaluate and create questions.
- **Graphic Organizer:** Elaborate – Character Body-Outline Organizer.

- **Differentiated Instruction:** Elaborate – scaffolded text cards for targeted tiers.
- **Peer Assessment (Star and Wish):** Elaborate – pairs check another pair's organizer.
- **Traffic-Light Self-Assessment and Exit Ticket:** Evaluate – individual check on external characterization.

Subject Integration

- **Social Studies (Engage):** Students discuss how people in their community judge status by clothes, shoes or cars, and link this to how Palmer dresses Jake and Sun-Sun.
- **Visual Arts (Elaborate):** Students sketch their character on the body outline, drawing the clothing and posture described in their quotes.

Classroom Organization and Management

- **Classroom layout and safety:** Desks are arranged in pairs, with the Sun-Sun pairs on one side of the room and the Jake pairs on the other for the jigsaw. Bags hang on the backs of chairs and walkways are kept clear so the teacher can reach every group.
- **Materials:** Cards, strips and worksheets are prepared in labelled envelopes before the lesson, so no time is lost handing them out.
- **Group roles:** For group tasks, each member receives a role slip (see the slips in the procedure) so every student knows exactly what to do and no one is left out.
- **Transitions:** The teacher uses the call-and-response "Class, class!" / "Yes, yes!" as an attention signal, and a visible timer shows how long each phase lasts.
- **Positive reinforcement:** Specific verbal praise, group points on the board, and good work displayed on the word wall.
- **Expectations:** Listen when others speak, respect every answer, share tasks fairly, and handle materials carefully.

Accommodations (Inclusion)

- **Reading difficulties:** Large-print cards and a reading partner; the teacher reads text aloud on request.
- **Writing difficulties:** Students may answer orally, point to the correct card, or have a peer scribe one answer.
- **Attention or vision needs:** Preferential seating near the board and the teacher.
- **Absent students:** Students who miss the lesson (for example, for sports) receive the notes and classwork as a catch-up pack.

Backup Plan (No Technology)

- **If there is no electricity, internet or projector:** The definitions and comparison columns are written on the whiteboard; the real gift parcel and box are used as planned.

5E PROCEDURE

1. ENGAGEMENT (10 minutes)

- **Activating Prior Knowledge:** The teacher asks: "Last week, what did Robin Hill's grand house tell us about the Johnson family?" Students fill in the K and W columns of their KWL chart on characters.

KWL Chart: Characters (one per student)

K – What I Know	W – What I Want to Know	L – What I Learned
e.g. Sun-Sun is Rami's father.	*e.g. How do writers show what a character is like?*	*(Completed in Evaluate)*

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will look at a neatly wrapped gift parcel placed next to a worn cardboard box. Students discuss the assumptions people make based on the outside wrapping, and relate this to how readers form first impressions of characters from physical descriptions.
- **Student Action:** Students copy the definition of External Characterization into their notebooks.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will display the two objects, guide the discussion linking packaging to how characters are introduced, and add the key term to the class Vocabulary Wall. The teacher will ask:
- Which box would you choose? Why?
- What do you think is inside each box? How do you know?
- Can you really tell what is inside just by looking at the outside? How is this like meeting a character in a story?

Key Definition (Vocabulary Wall)

External Characterization: how a writer shows what a character is like on the outside: physical appearance, clothing, posture, facial expressions and the way they move.

- **Subject Integration (Social Studies):** Students discuss how people in their community judge status by clothes, shoes or cars, and link this to how Palmer dresses Jake and Sun-Sun.
- **Technology (in class):** The definition is shown on a PowerPoint slide while the objects are on the teacher's desk.
- **Formative Check:** Students hold up one finger (outside) or two fingers (inside) as the teacher names five traits (e.g. tall, generous, hawk-nosed, greedy, smiling).

(Visual & Auditory)

2. EXPLORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will work in mixed-ability pairs: half the class skims Chapter 2 to track Sun-Sun Johnson, and the other half reads Chapter 3 to track Jake Hibbertson. Pairs extract three exact phrases or quotes showing how their character looks, dresses or moves, and write them on the draft worksheet.

Draft Worksheet (one per pair)

	Quote / phrase from the text	Page
Looks (appearance)		
Dresses (clothing)		
Moves (posture / gestures)		

Pair Role Slips (cut out; give one slip to each group member)

✂️ **Finder**
Skim the chapter and point out each phrase about how the character looks, dresses or moves.

✂️ **Recorder**
Underline the phrase in the book and copy it exactly onto the worksheet with the page number.

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will assign the characters, give page ranges, and check that pairs record exact text evidence rather than personal assumptions. The teacher will ask: "Where in the text does it say that?"
- **Formative Check:** The teacher checks that each pair has three quotes, each with a page number.
- **Feedback:** The teacher gives specific feedback, e.g. "'He looks mean' is your opinion. Find the words Palmer actually uses to describe his face."

(Auditory & Kinaesthetic)

3. EXPLANATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will listen as team representatives present their evidence. A student tracking Jake points out descriptions of his sharp appearance to contrast with a classmate's analysis of Sun-Sun's rugged, hardworking appearance. Students copy the definitions of Protagonist and Antagonist.

Key Definitions (students copy into notebooks)

External trait: a feature we can see on the outside, such as appearance, clothing, posture or expression (e.g. Jake's "hawk-nosed" face).

Internal trait: a quality on the inside, such as personality, values or feelings (e.g. Sun-Sun's generosity). Internal traits are studied next week.

Protagonist: the main character whose goals drive the story (Sun-Sun Johnson).

Antagonist: the character who opposes the protagonist (Jake Hibbertson).

Board Comparison Columns (completed from student data)

Sun-Sun Johnson	Jake Hibbertson

- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will map students' evidence into the comparison columns on the board, formalise the definitions, and show how clothing signals changing economic status in the novel.

Higher-Order Questions (whole-class discussion)

1. Analyse: Why does Palmer give Jake a "sleek, lizardy look"?
2. Compare: How does Sun-Sun's appearance differ from Jake's?
3. Evaluate: Can we judge a character by appearance alone? Justify your answer.
4. Create: Write one sentence describing a character's clothing that shows they are rich.

Guide answers: it suggests he is sly and cold, like a lizard; Sun-Sun looks rugged and hardworking, Jake looks sharp and sleek; no – appearance gives clues, but internal traits show who a person really is; accept any sentence with clear clothing details.

- **Technology (in class):** The comparison columns are shown on a PowerPoint slide and filled in on the whiteboard.
- **Formative Check:** Students say "external" or "internal" chorally for three traits the teacher reads.

(Visual & Auditory)

4. ELABORATION (15 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will use their extracted details to complete the double-sided Character Body-Outline Organizer, writing physical markers on the outside zones of the diagram to show how posture and clothing reflect social standing. Students then check that every trait matches the text.

Character Body-Outline Organizer (zones to label)

Head and face (expression)	Body (clothing)	Posture / movement

- **Differentiation Support:** Selected pairs use pre-cut Evidence Cards to sort and place text traits onto the outlines under timed conditions.
- **Differentiation Extension:** Extended pairs write a short comment under each trait, evaluating how the clothing detail shows a shift in economic power.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will hand out the organizers, give scaffolded text cards to targeted tiers, and review students' connections.
- **Subject Integration (Visual Arts):** Students sketch their character on the body outline, drawing the clothing and posture described in their quotes.
- **Numeracy Link:** Pairs count how many traits they placed in each zone and write the total as a fraction of the traits they found (e.g. 2 out of 6 are about clothing).
- **Peer Assessment:** Pairs swap organizers with a pair who tracked the other character, check that each trait has a quote, and give one star and one wish.
- **Feedback:** The teacher reviews one organizer with the class, praising exact quotes and correcting any personal opinions recorded as traits.

(Kinaesthetic & Visual)

5. EVALUATION (10 minutes)

- **Student Learning Activity:** Students will complete the exit ticket quietly and on their own, then complete the L column of the KWL chart and the traffic-light self-assessment.
- **Teacher Facilitation:** The teacher will collect the organizers, make sure students complete the exit ticket on their own, and collect the slips to check which students still confuse external and internal traits.

Exit Ticket

1. Is a character's choice of clothing an external or an internal trait?
2. Quote or describe one physical trait of Jake Hibbertson from Chapter 3.
3. What does this trait help the reader picture about his status or position?

Teacher Answers: Exit Ticket

1. External. 2. e.g. tall and slim; "hawk-nosed"; "sleek, lizardy look"; scattered teeth. 3. Accept a reasoned answer, e.g. he seems sharp, cold and powerful.

- **Self-Assessment:** Students rate each statement with a traffic light.

Traffic-Light Self-Assessment (students tick one colour for each statement)

I can…	Green	Yellow	Red
tell external traits from internal traits	☐	☐	☐
find a quote that describes a character's appearance	☐	☐	☐
explain what a character's appearance shows	☐	☐	☐

Green = I can do this on my own. Yellow = I need a little more practice. Red = I need help.

- **Closure:** One student completes the sentence aloud: "An external trait is…"
- **Positive Reinforcement:** The teacher praises pairs who found exact quotes and awards class points.

(Visual & Auditory)

Total: 10 + 15 + 10 + 15 + 10 = 60 minutes

Homework / Extension Assignment

No formal graded homework is assigned for this block. Review your notebook entries on external traits to prepare for the term project guidelines next week.

Who are the Characters? (Teacher's Guide)

Based on the text in Chapters 2 and 3, here is the cast of characters students will meet:

Core characters for the lesson

- **Sun-Sun Johnson (Merton Johnson):** Rami's father. Formerly the wealthiest "big shot" farmer in the village. He is an eccentric, deeply loving, boyish and generous man who trusted everyone to a fault, lost his grip on his wealth, fell into a desperate cycle of gambling, and lost his estate. Despite his massive loss, he has rock-bottom resilience.
- **Jake Hibbertson (the "Rake"):** The primary antagonist. A tall, slim, hawk-nosed man with scattered teeth and a "sleek, lizardy look". He is cold, ruthless and driven entirely by money and power. He has taken over Sun-Sun's property and is the leading economic power in the village (and chairman of the school board).

Supporting characters in these chapters

- **Rami Johnson:** The narrator, fifteen at the start of the novel ("I was fifteen then", Chapter 1); he is sixteen by Chapter 8 and seventeen at the end. He is deeply loyal to his father and chose to stay with him at the River Bottom cabin rather than live in comfort with his mother. He is the analytical eyes of the story and deeply resents Jake's craftiness.
- **Ma (Debbie):** Sun-Sun's ex-wife and Rami's mother. Driven by ambition and a desire for respectability, she grew hoarse protesting Sun-Sun's reckless generosity and left him (and later divorced him) after he lost his grip on his money and began to gamble. She teaches at the local high school.
- **Arlene and Brad:** Rami's younger siblings (aged 12 and 10), who live with their mother. They are too young to understand the rivalry and are easily charmed by rides in Jake's sleek Jaguar.
- **Mrs. Betty Hilcher:** A kind, thin, welcoming widow who lives across the river from Sun-Sun's new cabin. She welcomes them with a corn pone pudding.
- **Donna Rae Hilcher:** Mrs. Hilcher's daughter, Rami's age and in his class. A pretty, dimpled, expressive "tomboy" who becomes a kindred spirit and friend to Rami.
- **Miss Fletcher:** Rami's form teacher, who is frustrated with his poor school performance, possibly influenced by the fact that Jake is chairman of the school board.

Chapter 2 & 3 Teacher's Characterization Key (book page / PDF page)

Character	Trait / description (text evidence)	Type	Page
Sun-Sun	"…his arms hung heavy and limp from his broad shoulders."	External (physical build)	28 / 29
Sun-Sun	"…biting his lips when something went wrong or shaking his head but smiling shortly after…"	External (expressions/habits)	30 / 31
Sun-Sun	"…polite but making it as pleasant as ever. None of that stiff stuff from him."	External (mannerisms/posture)	31 / 32
Sun-Sun	"In the lamplight I had one glimpse of Father's face. It was set. To me it was set harder than granite."	External (facial expression)	36 / 37
Sun-Sun	"He spent so much on things to make us happy… Father had always cared about us, too much in fact."	Internal (values/motivations)	18 / 19
Sun-Sun	Lenient, overly generous, and forgiving to a fault with thieves and poor workers.	Internal (personality)	18, 20 / 19, 21
Sun-Sun	Non-materialistic: "So what the hell's money? It isn't life, is it?"	Internal (belief system)	19 / 20
Sun-Sun	Boyish and playful; loves to build fishpots and tops for village boys and guffaws "more than a hyena."	Internal (personality)	21 / 22
Sun-Sun	Trusting to his own detriment: "Trusting everyone and being exploited by just about everyone."	Internal (personality flaw)	22 / 23
Jake	Called "the Rake" because "…he was tall and slim too and his teeth were a bit scattered around in his mouth."	External (physical features)	22–23 / 23–24
Jake	"…hawk-nosed…"	External (facial feature)	23 / 24
Jake	"His hairline had receded and, without the hat, he had that brushed sleek, lizardy look."	External (appearance)	23 / 24–25
Jake	"He was as stiff as wood and cold without life."	External (posture/presence)	17 / 18
Jake	"…Jake was still smiling, no wider, no narrower."	External (facial expression)	24 / 25
Jake	"…thinking money and nothing else in this wide world."	Internal (motivations)	18 / 19

Jake	Ruthless and power-hungry: "Jake was a wolf for prestige and power." He demands formal titles ("Mr. Hibbertson").	Internal (desires/values)	19 / 20
Jake	Unforgiving, harsh and litigious: frequently sends neighbours to jail or penalizes them for crop damages.	Internal (personality)	19 / 20

Technology Integration (Homework & Practice)

- **Google Classroom:** Post the Character Profile Handout and today's definitions so students can review them at home.
- **Quizizz:** Assign an optional practice quiz sorting traits as external or internal, using Sun-Sun and Jake as examples.

Assessment Summary

Type	What is assessed
Diagnostic	KWL chart (K and W); gift-box discussion.
Formative	Pair quote extraction; body-outline organizers with peer feedback; Quizizz practice report.
Summative	Exit ticket.

Success Criteria

Students are successful when they can correctly categorize clothing and appearance as external traits and extract two accurate physical text references without confusing them with personality traits.

Link to Previous and Next Lesson

- **Previous:** Week 2 – Setting and atmosphere in Chapter 1.
- **Next:** Week 4 – Characterization: internal traits and motivation in Chapter 4.

APA References

- Ministry of Education, Youth and Information. (2018). *National Standards Curriculum: Language and Literature Grades 7–9*. Kingston, Jamaica: MoEYI.
- Ministry of Education, Skills, Youth and Information. (n.d.). *Curriculum analysis: Essential objectives & content focus – NSC Grades 7–9* (2nd ed.). Kingston, Jamaica.
- Palmer, C. E. (1974). *My father, Sun-Sun Johnson*. Macmillan Caribbean.
- Tomlinson, C. A. (2014). *The differentiated classroom: Responding to the needs of all learners* (2nd ed.). ASCD.

Lesson Evaluation (complete after teaching)

What went well:

What to improve:

Students who need follow-up: